



China tests robot Ship

China's robotic boat for launching sounding rockets that to understand the atmosphere over Earth's oceans. <https://digit.in/mar19-91>



Strobe-light causing hallucinations

Russian Navy claims two of its warships armed with a strobe weapon to cause hallucinations and more. <https://digit.in/mar19-92>

LG V40 ThinQ

Underrated champion

W

hat we found interesting in the LG V40 ThinQ is the endless number of features

we spent days exploring and understanding, features that go beyond just sheer speed, in almost every aspect of the smartphone experience. Some of these features make the LG V40 ThinQ sound like a steal, but does it fare well in usage?

Design

In comparison to the bling and glamour that most flagship phones indulge in, the LG V40 ThinQ is subtle, classy and premium. There are the flagship-grade excesses you tend to find on expensive phones like the sheer number of cameras on the phone, but it's all arranged and aligned so well, it all seems perfectly reasonable to have. In a lot of ways, the phone felt like an elder brother of the LG G7+ ThinQ.

Display

LG pegs the V-series as one made for 'creators', and a large display plays a major factor in boosting the multimedia capabilities of a phone. If you are a display nerd, however, you might end up spending hours calibrating the display. LG offers a full suite of display calibration. LG's panel also feels quite vibrant among flagships.

Performance

The flagship Snapdragon 845 chipset ensures the LG V40 ThinQ runs without a hitch. There was no visible slowdowns or lags even though the LG UI is quite processor-intensive. However, in the middle of a typical work day, we found barely 22 percent RAM available. But with Google Keep and Google Chrome open in split-screen, it didn't give us any grief. When it comes to gaming though, the LG V40 ThinQ



Price
₹49,990



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isn't the best phone around for playing popular titles like Asphalt 9 and PUBG Mobile.

Audio

When using a wired headset, the LG V40 uses the 32-bit HiFi DAC to amplify the audio. The real impact of the DAC will be

felt if you're listening to lossless audio through high-impedance headphones. There's also DTS: X 3D surround sound. There are situations when you need to play audio out loud for people around you to hear and the boombox speaker comes handy. While most phones these days have good enough audio, the LG V40 lets you go the extra mile to prove your audiophile status.

Software and UI

The LG V40 ThinQ looks quite polished from the inside. It does take some time to finally get everything in order. When you set it up for the first time, you'll likely spend a lot of time in the Settings app. There's a great degree of customisation on offer as well. The fingerprint sensor on the device is super responsive, but the face recognition is nowhere as fast as popular competitors such as the OnePlus 6T.

Camera

The LG V40 ThinQ's camera is nowhere close to what the Pixel 3 can do, but it can easily give a Samsung Galaxy S9 a run for its money for its accurate colour reproduction and dynamic range, but not so much on the details and in low-light. The LG V40 ThinQ, apart from the LG G7+ ThinQ is the only phone right now that can shoot HDR videos. The phone's stabilisation is super useful while shooting videos. When using the standard lens, there's 3-axis OIS while on the others, you have EIS.

Battery

The phone lasted around six hours on Geekbench's battery test while in our in-house video loop test where we play a 10-minute on loop till 5 percent battery with screen brightness to 100 percent, it lasted 5 hours 40 minutes. Considering how this phone is pegged at creators who are expected to go out and shoot in obscure locations, the battery life is a real deal-breaker. The fast charger that comes with the box tops up the phone in around 105 minutes.

Verdict

The LG V40 ThinQ is a pure bred flagship phone that doesn't just rely on flagship hardware under the hood to set itself apart. It actually puts them to good use where all the resources are put to good use. You might be interested in it if creating videos is your bread and butter. The phone isn't meant for heavy gaming. If you don't need the telephoto lens and the wide-angle camera on the front, go for the LG G7+ ThinQ instead. It's more compact and has better ergonomics. You should also stay away from the phone if you want regular updates.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DIMENSIONS: 158.8 x 75.7 x 7.6 mm | WEIGHT: 169 g | DISPLAY: P-OLED 6.4 inches | RESOLUTION: 1440 x 3120 | CHIPSET: Qualcomm SDM845 Snapdragon 845 | CARD SLOT: microSD, up to 512 GB (dedicated slot) | INTERNAL MEMORY: 64/128 GB, 6 GB RAM | LOUDSPEAKER: Yes | 3.5MM JACK: Yes | BATTERY: 3300mAh

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